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EBAY & ETSY | North America

EBAY and ETSY in the Agentic Era: Underappreciated Advantages?

With agentic commerce set to be the next paradigm shift across eComm, we dive into how EBAY & ETSY are positioned and size agentic bull & bear cases. Despite the market's skepticism, we come out more optimistic as we see unique, underappreciated advantages for both companies.

Key Takeaways

- Entering the era of agentic commerce, we assess EBAY & ETSY's positioning and size scenarios from here
- EBAY (OW, \$121 PT): An underappreciated agentic winner given a highly differentiated inventory base; our favorite name in SMID eCommerce
- ETSY (EW \$64 PT): Although there are clear long-term risks, we see a more compelling medium-term opportunity that could drive GMS growth and lead to a re-rating
- We take a deep dive into how EBAY & ETSY perform on our "5 I's Framework" for retailers in agentic commerce...
- ... and also model out new agentic bull and bear cases for EBAY/ETSY with potential for up to 30%/40% upside to 2030 EBITDA

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We Think The Market is Underestimating EBAY and ETSY Entering the Agentic

Era: We believe agentic commerce is set to be a paradigm shift for eCommerce: moving from keyword-based search boxes to interactive, personalized shopping assistants. It's still early in the evolution, but we think assessing positioning is critical as agentic shopping likely drives eCommerce penetration while accelerating market share shifts. Within SMID eCommerce, **EBAY and ETSY have been the most debated with investors largely skeptical of how both are positioned.** We analyzed each name in depth on our "5 I's" framework for retailers in agentic commerce and

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INTERNET

North America

Industry View

Attractive

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quantified potential agentic bull & bear cases for EBAY & ETSY. **We feel the market is underappreciating EBAY's structural advantages** with a unique inventory moat. **Long-term risks at ETSY are clear, but have masked an intriguing medium-term opportunity.**

For our initial deep dive on agentic commerce, see: [Internet: Agentic Shoppers Are Coming... Who Could Win or Lose?](#)

EBAY (OW, \$121 PT): An Underappreciated Agentic Winner... EBAY's long-held perception as a structural share loser (recent performance notwithstanding) has driven skepticism on its ability to outperform as agentic commerce gains steam. We disagree & see it as particularly well positioned with multiple structural advantages. First, EBAY's massive ~2.5B listings base is highly unique with ~90% used or not in-season. Agentic should better surface these long-tail items from EBAY's inventory, driving GMV upside. Second, the large base of used & C2C inventory give it a pricing advantage over many other retailers which should lead to higher visibility. Third, agentic commerce should remove fiction from the selling experience - fueling listing growth & quality. Taken together, **we see EBAY as one of the best positioned eCommerce names for agentic commerce which could enable durable ~HSD% GMV growth and support a multiple re-rating.** In our new EBAY agentic bull case we outline a path for 2030 GMV/EBITDA to come in 26%/30% above our base case.

... & Strong Fundamental Performance Makes It Our Favorite Name in SMID eCommerce: EBAY is set to deliver ~12% y/y FXN GMV growth in 1H26, well above what was thought possible just a year ago. Despite that, the market believes this recent growth is temporary and will fade shortly. Conversely, we see the improvement as largely structural with much of the outperformance attributable to idiosyncratic gains. EBAY has materially enhanced the experience in key categories like trading cards while also launching cross-category improvements such as AI selling tools. The company also has embedded call options in agentic commerce & live selling - neither of which are meaningfully included in estimates. All in, we think MSD%-HSD% GMV growth is achievable which will deliver operating leverage in time, leading EPS to compound solidly DD%. Although valuation has re-rated to 16x adj. '27 EPS, we see potential for multiple expansion if perceived as an agentic winner as many mature marketplaces have traded durably >20x P/E. Taken together, **OW EBAY is our favorite name in SMID eComm with a strong fundamental story and emerging agentic upside.**

ETSY (EW, \$64 PT): Long-term Risks Are Clear... There are clear concerns about ETSY's long-term positioning in an agentic era. The premise is simple: **ETSY's value is aggregating demand for special items. If customers start their shopping journeys on horizontal agents' (like Gemini), those could displace ETSY as the aggregator.** ETSY could be at risk of this as its inventory is often not unique to Etsy.com - our analysis shows >75% of top ETSY sellers also sell on other channels. In addition, ETSY's ~25% take rate (the highest among public pure 3P marketplaces) creates an incentive for existing sellers to try and route demand to lower-cost channels. In a worst case scenario, this could look similar to in-person travel agents: previously able to capture a premium on largely commoditized supply, but share dissipated quickly once a better user experience with more competitive pricing arrived (online travel). This bear thesis is still speculative & requires a number of

assumptions, but it is hard to disprove which makes it likely to durably weigh on ETSY's multiple. Given these dynamics, in our ETSY agentic bear case we size how 2030 GMS/EBITDA could fall -11%/-41% below our base case.

... but the Market Is Overlooking a Compelling Medium-term Opportunity: With that being said, we see a clear path for ETSY to be an agentic winner within the next few years. The marketplace could uniquely benefit from agentic search as many buyers come with a mission in mind ("gift for my mom") rather than a specific item. The conversational nature of agentic allows buyers to refine what they are looking for far better than traditional search which should drive up conversion rate. ETSY has a window of opportunity to be the first with a dedicated agentic experience for special items as we believe that onsite experiences will be initially more adopted than horizontal agents given higher trust, lower payments/shipping friction, and existing consumer data. **The upside could be meaningful if agentic leads to higher conversion & frequency, for each \$5 increase in GMS per buyer ETSY's overall GMS would increase by 4%.** With consensus modeling just a 3% GMS 4-year CAGR, that means each \$5 increase represents more than a year of expected growth. We find this scenario easier to underwrite and in our ETSY agentic bull case we see potential for 2030 GMS/EBITDA to be 29%/40% above our base case.

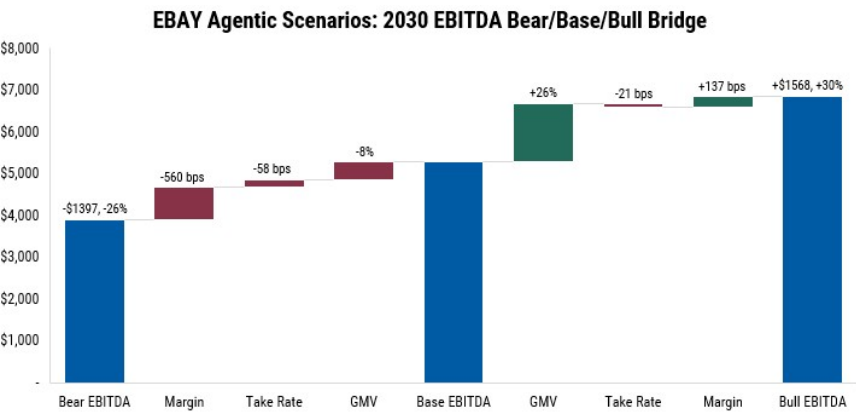
We take a deep dive applying our 5 I's framework for agentic commerce to EBAY & ETSY: With agentic set to be the next paradigm shift within eCommerce, we developed our "5 I's" framework to determine the balance of opportunity & risk for retailers. In the note, we break down positioning for both companies across each of the key variables. Using this framework, EBAY screens better than ETSY given its inventory moat and faster pace of innovation to date... although ETSY comes up less at risk than feared by the market with clear opportunity for market share gains.

Exhibit 1: Applying our 5 I's framework to EBAY & ETSY, full details in the note

ebay	Our 5 I's Framework	Etsy
A clear differentiator as ~90% of its inventory is unique (used or not in-season)	Inventory	Although ETSY sells unique items, they often aren't unique to ETSY
More physical touchpoints than expected, but room to improve	Infrastructure	Lack of physical distribution a long-run risk, but don't overlook its digital infrastructure
Pace of experimentation among the highest in SMID internet with a focus on enhancing its seller base	Innovation	ETSY has been a first mover for external partnerships, but early in developing onsite features
Opportunity across both horizontal agents & supply creation	Incrementality	Low share in a large TAM creates real opportunity
A wide range of potential outcomes, balanced versus peers	Income Statement Impact	A wide range of potential outcomes, less downside risk than perceived as marketing could see leverage
Underappreciated Agentic Commerce winner with a deep inventory moat & strong pace of innovation	Overall Agentic Positioning	Long-term risks are clear, but with high incrementality medium-term opportunity is far more compelling

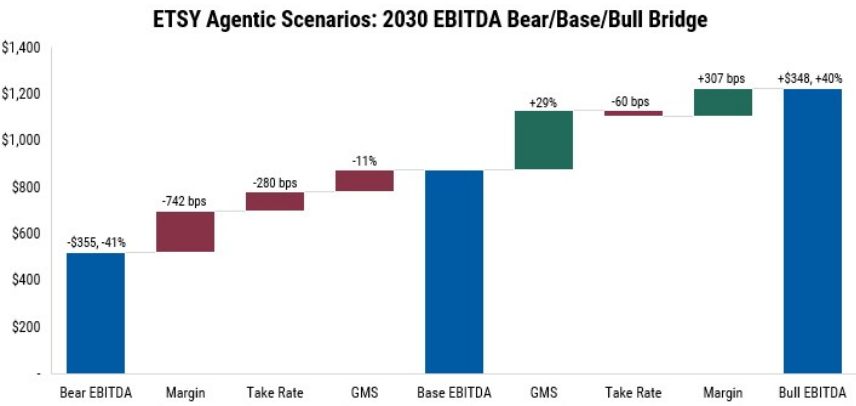
Source: Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 2: We outline agentic bull & bear scenarios for EBAY; upside largely driven by incremental GMV growth



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 3: We outline agentic bull & bear scenarios for ETSY; upside split between GMS growth and margin expansion while take rate is a concern in the bear case



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

EBAY (OW, \$121): An Underappreciated Agentic Winner

Our View

We see EBAY as an underappreciated agentic winner with 3 key strengths: EBAY has long held a perception as a structural share loser, recent performance notwithstanding. Given that, it's not a surprise the market has been skeptical of its ability to outperform as agentic commerce gains steam. However, we see 3 distinct advantages that we think will position it well for an agentic commerce era:

1) Vast, unique inventory: EBAY has a wide listing base of ~2.5B items. Of those, ~90% are used or not in-season, often being sold only on EBAY. Relative to existing keyword-based search, we think agentic commerce will help users refine in plain text what they want, getting them to long-tail items more frequently... which uniquely benefits EBAY's unique inventory.

2) Pricing advantage: As a marketplace without a dedicated fulfillment network, EBAY has a distinct speed disadvantage versus peers. However, what it lacks in speed it makes up in price. With a large base of used & C2C inventory, EBAY tends to offer goods at a material pricing advantage over retailers selling new items which should enable strong ranking among horizontal agents.

3) Reduced selling friction: People have >\$4K of items on average that they could sell online, but don't given it's still a relatively cumbersome experience. Agentic commerce should streamline this by automatically filling in structured data & providing recommendations on key pieces (title, description, price). By taking friction out of the process, both sellers and listings per seller should increase. Early datapoints are encouraging as the 2nd iteration of EBAY's Magical Listings is showing a >25% reduction in time to list and a >DD% increase in GMV per lister.

Taken together, **agentic commerce is a rare tech improvement that should drive both supply & demand** for EBAY and, as a result, we see it as one of the best positioned companies for agentic commerce. If we're right, we believe agentic could help fuel durable ~HSD%-LDD% GMV growth as we outline our new EBAY agentic bull case which has 2030 GMV/EBITDA 26%/30% above our base case..

5 I's Framework

What is our 5 I's Framework?

With agentic set to be the next major era within eCommerce, we have developed our "5 I's" framework to determine the balance of opportunity & risk for retailers. The 5 I's are:

1) Inventory: Unique, competitively priced inventory increasingly important as agentic makes it easier to cross-shop, compare prices, and match unique items to personalized tastes/demand.

2) Infrastructure: Access to physical infrastructure to quickly & cheaply deliver items along with digital

infrastructure to enable agentic sales.

3) Innovation: Investment/innovation to take advantage of GPU-enabled ML through things like better search & discovery, seller tools, external partnerships, etc.

4) Incremental Growth Opportunity: Ability to drive incremental topline growth and gain market share in a company's addressable market.

5) Income Statement and Margin Impact: The net impact to a company's margin structure, largely due to risk that agentic cannibalizes the higher margin core business and retail media ad earnings, but offset by a potential shift in marketing costs.

Inventory (5/5 - Very Strong Positioning): Highly unique inventory a clear differentiator

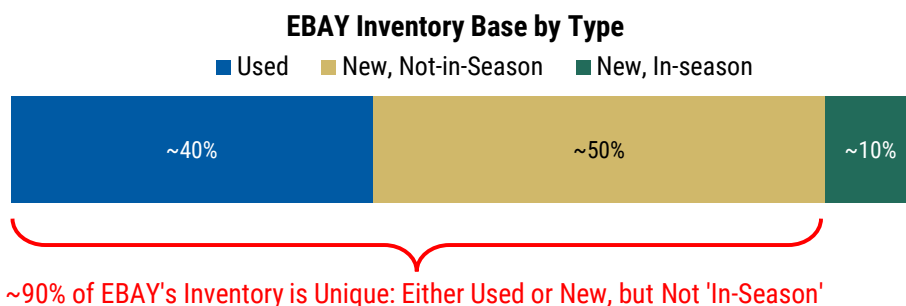
EBAY has 3 main advantages when it comes to inventory: scale, rarity, and pricing. Taken together we think this is a critical differentiator relative to eCommerce peers which often sell new, non-unique items.

1) Scale: EBAY has a vast listing base of ~2.5B items with a wide sourcing base across geographies, customer sizes, and categories.

2) Rarity: As 40% of items are pre-loved & another ~50% are new, but not in-season, many listings are unique or rare items not available elsewhere. As agentic is better at surfacing long-tail items than traditional search, we think EBAY's inventory should uniquely benefit.

3) Pricing: Given the above two factors (especially its used & C2C inventory), EBAY listings are often cheaper than peers.

Exhibit 4: ~90% of EBAY's inventory is unique, which we believe positions it well - offensively & defensively - for agentic commerce



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

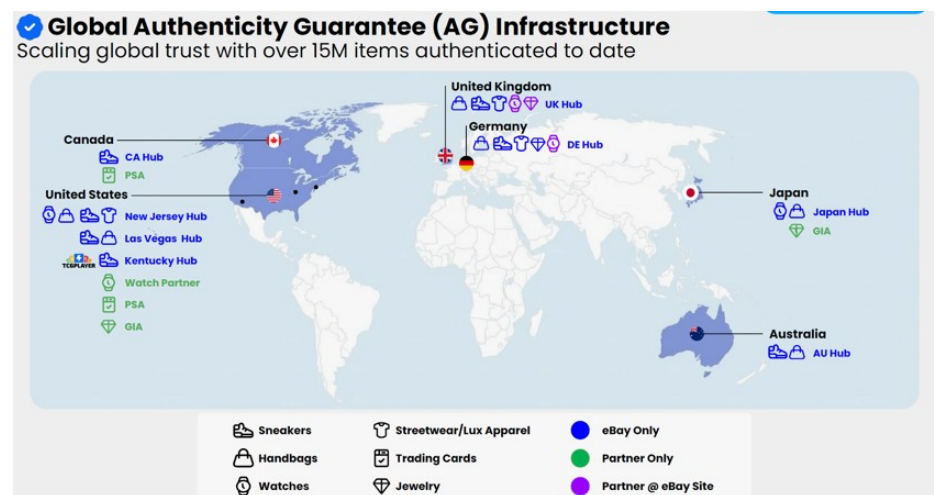
Infrastructure (3/5 - Neutral): More physical touchpoints than expected, but room to improve

We see physical fulfillment as a key differentiator as agentic grows. Given its broad

sourcing base/C2C exposure, EBAY hasn't built an owned fulfillment network which is a trade-off that sometimes leads to a worse consumer experience (slower shipping, inconsistent item accuracy). To address key pain points, EBAY has launched targeted fulfillment initiatives: 1) eBay International Shipping, 2) local managed shipping (in the UK/Australia), 3) SpeedPAK export-based shipping programs, and 4) authentication centers. This enables EBAY to manage the shipping experience where it can be most impactful without the full PnL impact of owning a global fulfillment network. We see further opportunity to expand this asset-light fulfillment assistance, particularly in domestic shipping (~80% of GMV).

On the digital infrastructure side, EBAY has built their "Unified Agentic Commerce platform" to enable agent-to-agent communication. However, it has done fewer partnerships with horizontal agents than peers like ETSY as it's focused on the onsite experience.

Exhibit 5: EBAY has 7 global authentication hubs along with 5 more partner facilities...



Source: Company Presentation

Exhibit 6: ...along with various Bespoke shipping programs across 14 countries

Facilitating Cross-Border Trade Through Shipping Solutions



* Managed shipping launched in Australia in 2Q

Source: Company Presentation

Innovation (4/5 - Strong Positioning): Pace of experimentation among the highest in SMID internet

Over the past 5 years, we've seen an accelerated pace of innovation at EBAY. This has led

the company to unexpectedly be on the leading edge of Gen AI among SMID internet names. Improvements have come in 3 buckets:

- 1) Listing assistance: Friction in listing items is one of the largest pain points on EBAY. GenAI has helped reduce time to list & may improve quality in time. Its new 'magical listings' flow saw a 25% decrease in average listing time and a +DD% increase in GMV per lister.
- 2) Seller tools: EBAY has worked to give sellers tool to reduce admin overhead, which can increase time spent on GMV-generating activities & lower seller churn.
- 3) Search & discovery: This is in earlier innings, but EBAY has trialed a few new types of engagement outside of keyword-based search. For example, agentic search beta is showing >50% higher engagement. We expect more to come here over time.

Exhibit 7: EBAY's key GenAI innovation to date across listing assistance, seller tools, and search & discovery

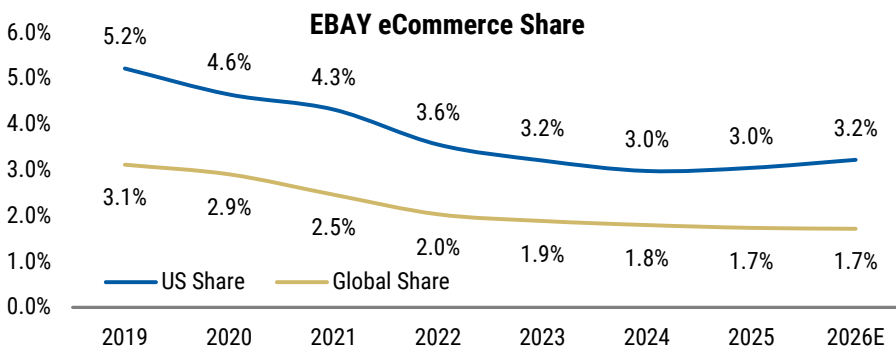
Listing Assistance	Seller Tools	Search & Discovery
GenAI Descriptions (2023): AI generated product descriptions for listings	Social Caption Generator (2023): AI generated captions for posting listings on social media	Shop the Look (2024): AI-based visual matches for fashion
Background Removal (2024): Enhanced picture backgrounds	GenAI Video Listings (2025): AI generated videos to post on social media	Explore Feed (2024): Picture-first discovery feed
Magical Bulk Listings (2024): Streamlined listing process for bulk items	AI Messaging Assistant (2025): Automated responses to common buyer questions	External Partnerships (2025): Started creating partnerships with horizontal agents
Next-Gen Magical Listings (2026): Significantly streamlined listing process	Inventory Mapping API (2025): Bulk inventory improvement tool from AI suggestions	Agentic Search (2026): On-site agent which can answer detailed questions

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Incrementality (3/5 - Neutral): Opportunity in horizontal agents & supply creation

On an aggregate basis, EBAY has a 3.0%/1.7% market share of the US/global eCommerce. However, it doesn't meaningfully compete in the majority of eCommerce spend (new, in-season inventory). Within its core verticals, share varies. However, we do see clear opportunity to capture demand through two methods. First, we think EBAY could outperform in horizontal agents given its competitively priced, scaled inventory base. Second, EBAY is unique in eCommerce as partially supply-constrained. Most people have a large number of items (~\$4K per household) which, if listed, would be partially incremental to GMV. By making it easier to list items, this unique supply should translate to share gains.

Exhibit 8: EBAY has ~3.0% market share within US eCommerce, although higher in its core verticals



Source: Census Bureau, Euromonitor, Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Income Statement Impact (3/5 - Neutral): A wide range of potential outcomes

In the early stages of agentic commerce, there are a wide variety of paths for how this could alter economics. The most important questions are: adoption of onsite (more profitable) vs. offsite (less profitable), the fee agents will be able to charge retailers (similar to an affiliate marketing), and the extent agentic grows the pie or simply cannibalizes existing sales.

Onsite agentic sales should not pressure margins, but offsite could. To assess the potential EBIT impact if offsite agentic commerce became 10% of GMV, we run a sensitivity analysis on Agent Fees (i.e. how much an offsite/horizontal shopping agent charges for sourcing the transaction) and Agentic Incremental GMV (i.e. how much of the Agentic GMV is new volume vs. cannibalizing purchases that would have otherwise still occurred).

At an agent fee of 5%, ~65% of EBAY's GMV would have to be incremental to reach breakeven EBIT. **That puts EBAY at an interesting middle ground versus peers** - it spends a relatively low amount on advertising (high risk agentic could increase that, hurting EBIT), but it generates minimal onsite ad revenue which reduces risk to take rate if onsite traffic is displaced by agents (lowering risk to EBIT).

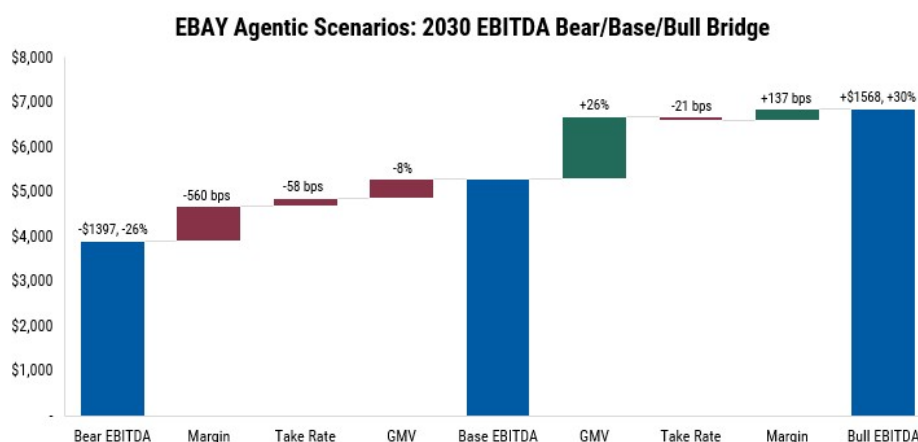
Exhibit 9: We sensitize the EBIT impact of offsite agents on EBAY

EBAY - Offsite Agentic Impact on EBIT @ 10% Share						
		Agent Fee				
		0.0%	2.5%	5.0%	7.5%	10.0%
Agentic % Incremental to GMV	10%	5%	(2%)	(8%)	(15%)	(21%)
	30%	8%	1%	(5%)	(12%)	(18%)
	50%	11%	5%	(2%)	(8%)	(15%)
	70%	14%	8%	1%	(5%)	(12%)
	90%	18%	11%	5%	(2%)	(8%)

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Scenario Analysis

Exhibit 10: EBAY Agentic Bear to Bull Case Waterfall



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Bull Case: Unique inventory keeps existing traffic onsite while offsite proves highly incremental

The vast assortment of unique inventory on EBAY allows it to be an agentic winner both onsite & offsite. Onsite, agentic improves the experience for enthusiasts buyers (~12% of the buyer base, but ~70% of GMV) improving both retention & spend. Offsite, agents surface its wide inventory (which is often priced at a discount) to other buyers which drives incremental volume. Those are magnified by improved seller tools which leads to a step-function increase in C2C inventory. Taken together, this leads to sustainable HSD%-LDD% GMV growth which puts '30 GMV 26% above our base case. This drives operating leverage and enables '30 EBITDA margin to expand 137 bps above our base case, or 30% higher EBITDA dollars.

Exhibit 11: EBAY in an Agentic Era - Bull Case

EBAY in an Agentic Era - Bull Case								
	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Non-Agentic GMV	73,206	74,667	79,609	86,557	91,327	94,896	96,652	97,099
Onsite Agentic GMV				1,117	3,046	7,238	14,476	23,938
Offsite Agentic GMV				372	1,015	2,413	4,825	7,979
Total GMV	73,206	74,667	79,609	88,047	95,389	104,547	115,954	129,015
y/y change		2.0%	6.6%	10.6%	8.3%	9.6%	10.9%	11.3%
Agentic % of GMV				2%	4%	9%	17%	25%
% delta vs. base case				1%	4%	10%	18%	26%
Take Rate	13.8%	13.8%	13.9%	14.0%	14.5%	14.9%	15.1%	15.3%
y/y change (bps)		-4	17	9	47	35	26	23
% delta vs. base case (bps)				-1	-3	-7	-14	-21
Non-Agentic Revenue	10,112	10,283	11,100	12,159	13,275	14,162	14,739	15,098
Onsite Agentic Revenue				157	443	1,080	2,207	3,722
Offsite Agentic Revenue				42	118	286	579	970
Revenue	10,112	10,283	11,100	12,358	13,836	15,528	17,525	19,791
y/y change		1.7%	7.9%	11.3%	12.0%	12.2%	12.9%	12.9%
% delta vs. base case				1%	4%	10%	17%	24%
Variable Costs	3,140	3,179	3,508	3,707	4,132	4,642	5,251	5,948
Marketing Costs	2,125	2,228	2,306	2,673	2,931	3,222	3,583	3,996
<u>Fixed Costs</u>	<u>2,196</u>	<u>2,000</u>	<u>2,378</u>	<u>2,732</u>	<u>2,824</u>	<u>3,032</u>	<u>3,254</u>	<u>3,493</u>
Total Costs	7,461	7,407	8,192	9,113	9,887	10,895	12,088	13,437
Variable Costs % of GMV	4.3%	4.3%	4.4%	4.2%	4.3%	4.4%	4.5%	4.6%
Marketing Costs % of GMV	2.9%	3.0%	2.9%	3.0%	3.1%	3.1%	3.1%	3.1%
<u>Fixed Costs % of GMV</u>	<u>3.0%</u>	<u>2.7%</u>	<u>3.0%</u>	<u>3.1%</u>	<u>3.0%</u>	<u>2.9%</u>	<u>2.8%</u>	<u>2.7%</u>
Total Costs % of GMV	10.2%	9.9%	10.3%	10.3%	10.4%	10.4%	10.4%	10.4%
EBITDA	3,140	3,179	3,443	3,760	4,389	5,097	5,930	6,860
y/y change		1.2%	8.3%	9.2%	16.7%	16.1%	16.4%	15.7%
% delta vs. base case				1%	5%	12%	20%	30%
EBITDA Margin	31.1%	30.9%	31.0%	30.4%	31.7%	32.8%	33.8%	34.7%
y/y change (bps)		-14	10	-60	130	110	102	82
% delta vs. base case (bps)				3	31	68	104	137

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Bear Case: Offsite agents disrupt EBAY's flywheel and return the company to sustained share loss

Despite its strong recent performance, EBAY has largely lost share through eCommerce's evolution. Agentic could revert EBAY to share losses by giving sellers the ability to list elsewhere and still generate demand - disrupting EBAY's flywheel. In addition, it may highlight EBAY's generally slower shipping times which could cause share loss. Offsite struggles to be as profitable as EBAY has to pay a higher marketing fee while also losing ad revenue. In this scenario, we model GMV flips back to modest declines with '30 GMV - 8% below our base case. Take rate is pressured given reduced onsite advertising revenue, leading it -58 bps below our base case in '30. This takes '30 revenue -12% below. Marketing spend increases due to agent fees, pushing '30 EBITDA -26% below our base

case to a 27.7% '30 margin.

Exhibit 12: EBAY in an Agentic Era - Bear Case

EBAY in an Agentic Era - Bear Case								
	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Non-Agentic GMV	73,206	74,667	79,609	86,059	86,230	82,224	73,793	62,022
Onsite Agentic GMV				745	2,031	4,826	9,651	15,958
Offsite Agentic GMV				745	2,031	4,826	9,651	15,958
Total GMV	73,206	74,667	79,609	87,548	90,292	91,875	93,095	93,939
y/y change		2.0%	6.6%	10.0%	3.1%	1.8%	1.3%	0.9%
Agentic % of GMV				2%	4%	11%	21%	34%
% delta vs. base case				0%	-1%	-3%	-6%	-8%
Take Rate	13.8%	13.8%	13.9%	14.0%	14.5%	14.8%	14.9%	15.0%
y/y change (bps)		-4	17	8	45	29	15	6
% delta vs. base case (bps)				-2	-7	-16	-34	-58
Non-Agentic Revenue	10,112	10,283	11,100	12,089	12,534	12,271	11,253	9,644
Onsite Agentic Revenue				105	295	720	1,472	2,481
Offsite Agentic Revenue				84	236	571	1,158	1,940
Revenue	10,112	10,283	11,100	12,278	13,066	13,563	13,883	14,065
y/y change		1.7%	7.9%	10.6%	6.4%	3.8%	2.4%	1.3%
% delta vs. base case				0%	-2%	-4%	-8%	-12%
Variable Costs	3,140	3,179	3,508	3,686	3,911	4,079	4,216	4,331
Marketing Costs	2,125	2,228	2,306	2,680	2,835	2,974	3,160	3,378
<u>Fixed Costs</u>	<u>2,196</u>	<u>2,000</u>	<u>2,378</u>	<u>2,732</u>	<u>2,749</u>	<u>2,841</u>	<u>2,912</u>	<u>2,968</u>
Total Costs	7,461	7,407	8,192	9,099	9,494	9,893	10,288	10,677
Variable Costs % of GMV	4.3%	4.3%	4.4%	4.2%	4.3%	4.4%	4.5%	4.6%
Marketing Costs % of GMV	2.9%	3.0%	2.9%	3.1%	3.1%	3.2%	3.4%	3.6%
<u>Fixed Costs % of GMV</u>	<u>3.0%</u>	<u>2.7%</u>	<u>3.0%</u>	<u>3.1%</u>	<u>3.0%</u>	<u>3.1%</u>	<u>3.1%</u>	<u>3.2%</u>
Total Costs % of GMV	10.2%	9.9%	10.3%	10.4%	10.5%	10.8%	11.1%	11.4%
EBITDA	3,140	3,179	3,443	3,693	4,010	4,133	4,088	3,895
y/y change		1.2%	8.3%	7.3%	8.6%	3.1%	-1.1%	-4.7%
% delta vs. base case				-1%	-4%	-9%	-17%	-26%
EBITDA Margin	31.1%	30.9%	31.0%	30.1%	30.7%	30.5%	29.4%	27.7%
y/y change (bps)		-14	10	-94	61	-22	-103	-175
% delta vs. base case (bps)				-30	-72	-167	-335	-560

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

ETSY (EW, \$64): Medium-Term Opportunity More Compelling Than Long-Term Risks

Our View

The long-term risks for ETSY in agentic commerce are clear...: We have concerns about ETSY's long-term positioning in an agentic era. The premise is simple: **ETSY's value is aggregating demand for special items. If somebody else aggregates that demand, what is ETSY's value?**

Although ETSY sells unique items, they often aren't unique to ETSY. We took a look at the top 100 shops on ETSY and found that >75% also sell on other channels (primarily SHOP sites), often at a discount to their pricing on ETSY. If horizontal agents (like Gemini) gain share, it's possible they may direct people to those individual sites rather than ETSY.

Risk of disruption is magnified by ETSY's 25% take rate, the highest among public 3P marketplaces. This provides an incentive for sellers to try and divert traffic away from ETSY if possible. In addition, the high onsite advertising revenue (~8% of GMS) could come under pressure if traffic moves from Etsy to offsite agents.

ETSY's low buyer loyalty may hasten any potential decline. ETSY has a ~60% annual buyer churn and generates >20% of its GMS from existing paid channels (primarily Google search). The company has been working to improve this by moving buyers to the app, but churn still runs far higher than most eCommerce peers.

Although this thesis is still highly theoretical, it's hard to disprove and we believe will durably weigh on ETSY's multiple. In our ETSY agentic bear case we model 2030 GMS/EBITDA -11%/-41% below our base case.

... but the market is overlooking the compelling medium-term opportunity: Despite the potential long-term risk, we see a very interesting opportunity for ETSY to be an agentic winner over the next few years that we believe the market does not appreciate.

We believe the biggest limitation to ETSY's GMS growth over the past decade has been a lack of frequency gains, despite heavy efforts from the company. We think this may have been a structural issue with keyword-based search. Many buyers come to Etsy with a mission in mind ("gift for my mom") rather than a specific item, while keyword-based search works best when a buyer knows exactly the item they want ("custom ceramic mug"). The conversational nature of agentic could fundamentally change that by allowing buyers to refine what they are looking for with far more context. We think this will drive up conversion rate and allow buyers to shop across a greater breadth of products/categories.

In addition, the bear case is focused on growth in horizontal agents. However, we believe that onsite agentic experiences will be initially more adopted given higher trust, lower payments/shipping friction, and ability to leverage customer data. That provides a window of opportunity for ETSY to build onsite agentic experiences that improve the customer experience, increase buyer retention, and potentially reactivate a portion of its >200M lapsed buyers. Plus it's possible ETSY performs better with horizontal agents than in

search, which could increase share.

The upside could be meaningful if agentic does lead to higher conversion & frequency. For each \$5 increase in GMS per buyer ETSY's overall GMS would increase by 4%. Given consensus is modeling just a 3% GMS CAGR, even moderate gains in frequency could lead to meaningful estimate revisions.

As a result, in our ETSY agentic bull case we model 2030 GMS 29% above our base case with margins remaining healthy as high onsite agentic adoption protects the take rate leading to 2030 EBITDA dollars 40% above our base case.

5 I's Framework

What is our 5 I's Framework?

With agentic set to be the next major era within eCommerce, we have developed our "5 I's" framework to determine the balance of opportunity & risk for retailers. The 5 I's are:

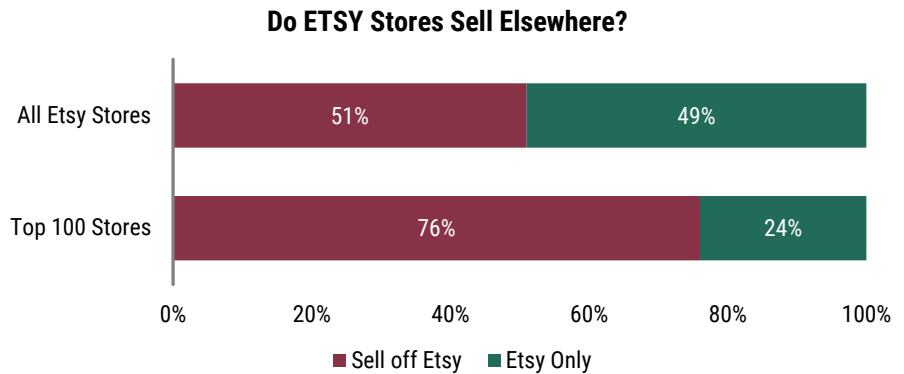
- 1) Inventory:** Unique, competitively priced inventory increasingly important as agentic makes it easier to cross-shop, compare prices, and match unique items to personalized tastes/demand.
- 2) Infrastructure:** Access to physical infrastructure to quickly & cheaply deliver items along with digital infrastructure to enable agentic sales.
- 3) Innovation:** Investment/innovation to take advantage of GPU-enabled ML through things like better search & discovery, seller tools, external partnerships, etc.
- 4) Incremental Growth Opportunity:** Ability to drive incremental topline growth and gain market share in a company's addressable market.
- 5) Income Statement and Margin Impact:** The net impact to a company's margin structure, largely due to risk that agentic cannibalizes the higher margin core business and retail media ad earnings, but offset by a potential shift in marketing costs.

Inventory (2/5 - Limited Differentiation): Although ETSY sells unique items, they often aren't unique to ETSY

Etsy's sellers primarily offer unique and special items. However, as a marketplace many of those items aren't unique to ETSY. The company has disclosed that ~49% of sellers exclusively sell on ETSY. However, that includes a number of small shops with limited volume. **We went through ETSY's top 100 sellers and found at least 3/4ths also sell on other channels** (primarily an owned website, but often other marketplaces). Given ETSY's ~25% take rate, this is logical. Sellers pay a premium to ETSY for demand generation, but will try and divert sales to their owned channels (like a SHOP site) as much as possible

given lower fees... and often offer lower prices as an incentive. This creates a risk for ETSY. If the same item is available for cheaper elsewhere, external agents are incentivized to push traffic towards those lower-cost channels (all else equal). We believe this inventory overlap may be a risk if horizontal agents gain share, pressuring volume and/or take rate.

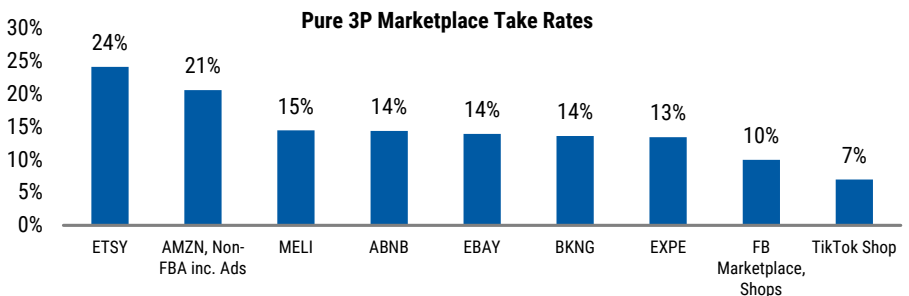
Exhibit 13: At least 3/4ths of ETSY's top sellers already sell on other channels, showing most inventory is not unique to Etsy.com



* A greater portion of the top 100 stores may sell off Etsy, but we only found direct evidence for 76%

Source: Marketplace Pulse, Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 14: ETSY has the highest take rate among 'pure' public marketplaces (those without fulfillment)



FY25 data

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

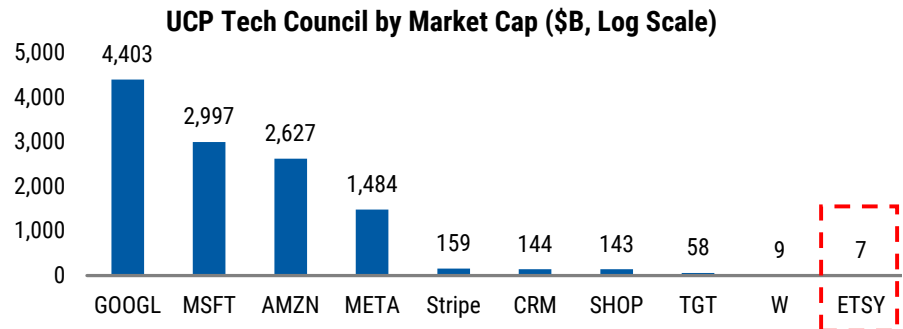
Infrastructure (2/5 - Limited Differentiation): Lack of physical distribution a long-run risk, but don't overlook its digital infrastructure

As a pure 3P marketplace ETSY doesn't have physical infrastructure. Given the long-tail nature of its seller-base & of handmade/custom-ordered goods, this isn't a space where that is fully feasible. However, this does reduce seller lock-in & moat which could become an issue long-term if external agents become 'the new marketplace'. Said another way, ETSY sellers will go to whomever offers demand. In a bear case, this could look similar to in-person travel agents where their primary value (aggregating demand for travel companies) was more easily displaced than other in-person businesses as they didn't control the supply or have a delivery moat. Granted, we see this as a long term risk which is far from guaranteed & will depend on how external agents look to monetize.

Near-term, the digital infrastructure ETSY has built will be more important. It has the

largest database of unique/special items with the specific attributes relevant to this category (critical for surfacing the right items for agents). In addition, it has partnered with the major consumer-facing agents to ensure its inventory is surfacing if demand moves. It has also been an early leader in agentic payments which gives it a seat at the table to try and move standards in its favor despite its relatively small size.

Exhibit 15: On GOOGL's UCP Tech Council, ETSY is the smallest company - showing its outsized impact on digital infrastructure relative to its size



* Stripe based on last publicly disclosed private valuation

Source: FactSet, Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Innovation (3/5 - Neutral): ETSY has been a first mover for external partnerships, but has been slower to launch onsite features

In innovation, ETSY has been a tale of two sides. Etsy has been a founding commerce partner for the major horizontal agentic platforms (Gemini, Copilot, etc.), uniquely testing out the new format while peers have been more stagnant. We think this will give them time to determine incrementality & optimize the experience. In addition, it gives them a voice to help shape how these features are developed - potentially shifting development more towards their priorities. By being a first mover, we think ETSY has a chance to drive a near-term GMS boost as it more quickly understands how to win in this new channel.

However, ETSY has been slower than others in launching onsite agentic features. The company's historical forte has been optimization rather than product launches which led to limited consumer-facing innovations in '23 & '24. However, we've started to see experimentation increase over the past few quarters with new seller tools being released in 3Q25 and buyer tools entering testing over the past few months.

Exhibit 16: ETSY has launched a variety of Gen AI features, with development accelerating over the past 12 months

ETSY Gen AI Features & Partnerships				
Feature	Type	Partner	Date	Details
AI Message Drafts	Seller Tool		9/4/2025	Gives proposed responses to buyer questions
Title Suggestions	Seller Tool		9/15/2025	Recommends new titles for listings
LLM-Attribute Tagging	Back-end		10/13/2025	Uses LLMs to extract additional information from listing photos & unstructured text
Copilot Checkout	Partnership	Microsoft	1/8/2026	Etsy items available to purchase directly in Copilot checkout on the web in the US
Direct Purchase in AI Mode/Gemini	Partnership	Google	1/11/2026	US users can purchase ETSY items directly in GOOGL's AI Mode/Gemini App
Universal Commerce Protocol	Partnership	Google	1/11/2026	Founding tech council partner of GOOGL's agentic payment standard
LLM-Improved Search	Back-end		1/16/2026	Using LLMs to determine the semantic relevance of search
Algotorial Curation	Buyer Tool		4/16/2026	Uses AI to find inventory for human-dictated trends in the app
Onsite Conversational Search	Buyer Tool		5/5/2026	Testing conversational search in gifting

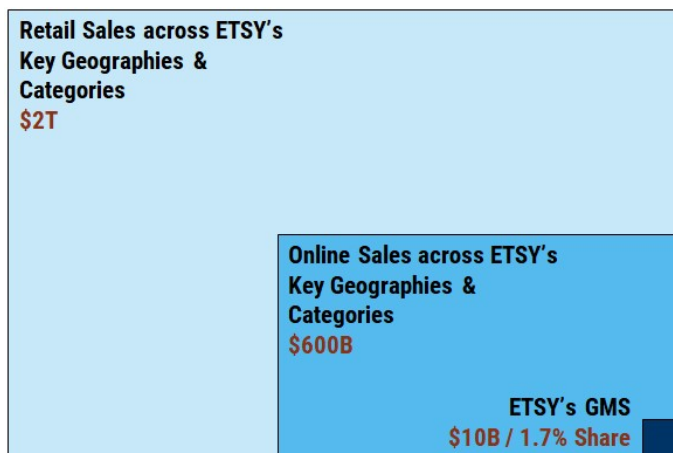
* List is not exhaustive

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Incrementality (5/5 - Very Strong Positioning): Low share in a large TAM creates real opportunity

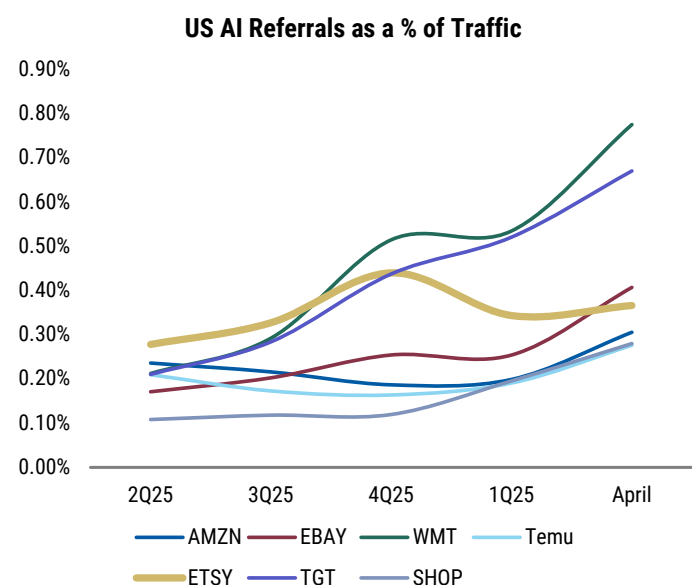
As a global marketplace that competes across various verticals Etsy has just ~1.7% eComm share of its ~\$600B self-defined TAM. Even if you cut the TAM simply to purchases for 'special' or custom items, it's still heavily underpenetrated. For most eCommerce players, the issue is lack of awareness & brand differentiation. That's not the case here as ETSY has ~87M active buyers & another ~200M lapsed buyers. Instead the issue has long been a lack of frequency with only ~\$120 GMS per buyer and ~60% annual buyer churn. GenAI could be the fix for frequency in two ways: 1) onsite agents enable an improved experience, or 2) external agents surface Etsy more than peers. With various paths for agentic to drive market share, we see clear potential for meaningful upside.

Exhibit 17: ETSY has just ~1.7% online share within its ~\$600B TAM or a ~0.5% share among its ~\$2T total (online/offline) TAM



Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Exhibit 18: Despite its early lead, ETSY has seen smaller incremental gains in AI referral traffic



Source: Similarweb, Morgan Stanley Research

Income Statement Impact (4/5 - Strong Positioning): A wide range of potential outcomes, less downside risk than perceived as marketing could see leverage

In the early stages of agentic commerce, there are a wide variety of paths for how this could alter economics. The most important questions are: adoption of onsite (more profitable) vs. offsite (less profitable), the fee agents will be able to charge retailers, and the extent agentic grows the pie or simply cannibalizes existing sales.

Onsite agentic sales should not pressure margins, but offsite could. To assess the potential EBIT impact if offsite agentic commerce became 10% of GMS, we run a sensitivity analysis on Agent Fees (i.e. how much an offsite/horizontal shopping agent charges for sourcing the transaction) and Agentic Incremental GMS (i.e. how much of the Agentic GMS is new volume vs. cannibalizing purchases that would have otherwise still occurred).

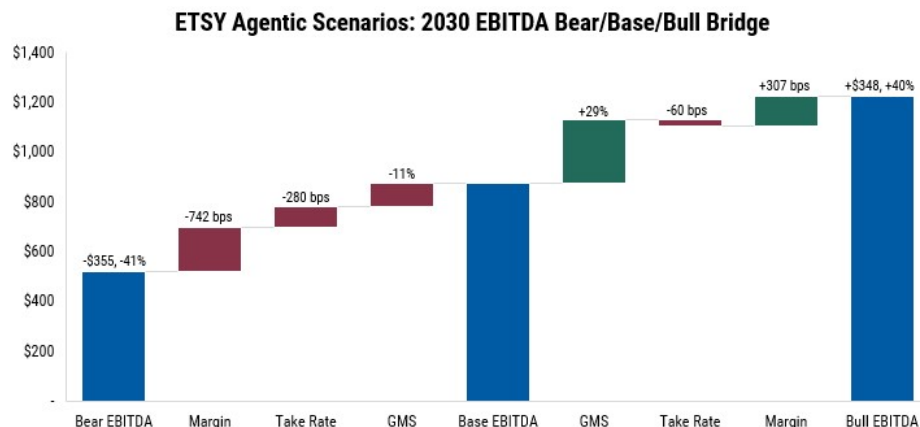
At an agent fee of 5%, just ~30% of ETSY's GMS would have to be incremental to reach breakeven EBIT. **Although the market is concerned about ETSY's agentic profitability given its high ad revenue, we think it overlooks ETSY's outsized marketing spend relative to peers.** That means ETSY may actually be able to offset the lower take rate with reduced marketing, leading to a slightly better breakeven curve than EBAY & many marketplaces. It likely performs best if agentic commerce looks similar to the existing search model with paid ads highly effective & a hurdle for smaller sites to gain visibility.

Exhibit 19: We sensitize the EBIT impact of offsite agents on ETSY

ETSY - Offsite Agentic Impact on EBIT @ 10% Share						
		Agent Fee				
		0.0%	2.5%	5.0%	7.5%	10.0%
Agentic % Incremental to GMV	10%	4%	0%	(4%)	(7%)	(11%)
	30%	7%	4%	0%	(3%)	(7%)
	50%	11%	7%	4%	0%	(3%)
	70%	14%	11%	7%	4%	0%
	90%	18%	15%	11%	8%	4%

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Scenario Analysis

Exhibit 20: ETSY Agentic Bull/Bear Waterfall

Source: Company Reports, Morgan Stanley Research

Bull Case: Onsite agentic improves search & discovery, driving up frequency and enabling marketing leverage

We see a very interesting opportunity for ETSY to be an agentic winner over the next few years. ETSY could uniquely benefit from agentic search as many buyers come with a mission in mind ("gift for my mom") rather than a specific item. The conversational nature of agentic allows buyers to refine what they are looking for far better than traditional search, which should drive up conversion rate. Onsite agentic features could lead to meaningful upside through higher conversion, fueling improved frequency. In our agentic bull case, this enables GMS growth to reaccelerate to HSD%-LDD% given the improved frequency, leading '30 GMS 29% above our base case. The improved frequency allows ETSY to gain leverage on its marketing with '30 EBITDA margin ~307 bps above our base case & leading '30 EBITDA dollars 40% ahead of our base case to \$1.2B.

Exhibit 21: ETSY in an Agentic Era - Bull Case

ETSY in an Agentic Era - Bull Case								
	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Non-Agentic GMS	13,161	12,587	11,917	10,681	10,854	10,855	10,585	10,137
Onsite Agentic GMS				178	486	1,156	2,311	3,822
Offsite Agentic GMS				45	122	289	578	956
Total GMS	13,161	12,587	11,917	10,904	11,462	12,300	13,475	14,915
y/y change		-4.4%	-5.3%	-8.5%	5.1%	7.3%	9.5%	10.7%
Agentic % of GMS				2%	5%	12%	21%	32%
% delta vs. base case				1%	4%	10%	19%	29%
Take Rate	20.9%	22.3%	24.2%	25.8%	26.0%	26.0%	25.9%	25.7%
y/y change (bps)		143	189	163	14	2	-11	-17
% delta vs. base case (bps)				-4	-10	-22	-40	-60
Non-Agentic Revenue	2,748	2,808	2,884	2,762	2,829	2,845	2,781	2,666
Onsite Agentic Revenue				46	127	303	607	1,005
Offsite Agentic Revenue				8	21	49	98	162
Revenue	2,748	2,808	2,884	2,816	2,976	3,197	3,486	3,834
y/y change		2.2%	2.7%	-2.3%	5.7%	7.4%	9.1%	10.0%
% delta vs. base case				1%	4%	9%	17%	26%
Variable Costs	792	742	790	755	806	876	969	1,082
Marketing Costs	733	833	900	804	841	886	939	997
<u>Fixed Costs</u>	<u>564</u>	<u>570</u>	<u>580</u>	<u>483</u>	<u>505</u>	<u>526</u>	<u>553</u>	<u>585</u>
Total Costs	2,089	2,145	2,270	2,043	2,151	2,289	2,462	2,664
Variable Costs % of GMS	6.0%	5.9%	6.6%	6.9%	7.0%	7.1%	7.2%	7.3%
Marketing Costs % of GMS	5.6%	6.6%	7.6%	7.4%	7.3%	7.2%	7.0%	6.7%
<u>Fixed Costs % of GMS</u>	<u>4.3%</u>	<u>4.5%</u>	<u>4.9%</u>	<u>4.4%</u>	<u>4.4%</u>	<u>4.3%</u>	<u>4.1%</u>	<u>3.9%</u>
Total Costs % of GMS	15.9%	17.0%	19.0%	18.7%	18.8%	18.6%	18.3%	17.9%
EBITDA	754	782	735	834	890	959	1,076	1,222
y/y change		3.6%	-6.0%	13.6%	6.7%	7.8%	12.2%	13.6%
% delta vs. base case				1%	5%	13%	25%	40%
EBITDA Margin	27.4%	27.8%	25.5%	29.6%	29.9%	30.0%	30.9%	31.9%
y/y change (bps)		38	-236	415	27	10	87	102
% delta vs. base case (bps)				12	46	109	200	307

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

Bear Case: ETSY loses its position as the aggregator for unique & special items, pressuring GMS and take rate

In this scenario, horizontal/offsite agents quickly gain traction. This disrupts ETSY's core value proposition as the aggregator of demand for bespoke & special items. Given ETSY's high take rates, sellers try and route demand to other channels (such as their own websites) where fees are lower - potentially undercutting on price. In addition, when sales are made through horizontal agents, ETSY doesn't get its lucrative ad revenue. Taken together, the bear case would have two major PnL impacts: GMS declines due to share loss & take rates are pressured given lower ad revenue. As a result, we model structural GMS declines with our '30 GMS -11% below our base case. The reduction in onsite ad revenue leads '30 take rate to be ~280 bps below our base case. That drives meaningful deleverage with '30 EBITDA margin falling to just 21.4% which puts EBITDA dollars -41% below our base case.

Exhibit 22: ETSY in an Agentic Era - Bear Case

ETSY in an Agentic Era - Bear Case								
	2023	2024	2025	2026E	2027E	2028E	2029E	2030E
Non-Agentic GMS	13,161	12,587	11,917	10,602	10,209	9,270	7,652	5,542
Onsite Agentic GMS				78	213	506	1,011	1,672
Offsite Agentic GMS				145	395	939	1,878	3,106
Total GMS	13,161	12,587	11,917	10,825	10,817	10,715	10,542	10,320
y/y change		-4.4%	-5.3%	-9.2%	-0.1%	-0.9%	-1.6%	-2.1%
Agentic % of GMS				2%	6%	13%	27%	46%
% delta vs. base case				0%	-2%	-4%	-7%	-11%
Take Rate	20.9%	22.3%	24.2%	25.7%	25.7%	25.4%	24.6%	23.5%
y/y change (bps)		143	189	155	-1	-33	-78	-112
% delta vs. base case (bps)				-12	-33	-81	-165	-280
Non-Agentic Revenue	2,748	2,808	2,884	2,742	2,661	2,429	2,010	1,458
Onsite Agentic Revenue				20	55	133	266	440
Offsite Agentic Revenue				25	67	160	319	528
Revenue	2,748	2,808	2,884	2,786	2,783	2,721	2,595	2,425
y/y change		2.2%	2.7%	-3.4%	-0.1%	-2.2%	-4.6%	-6.6%
% delta vs. base case				0%	-3%	-7%	-13%	-20%
Variable Costs	792	742	790	750	761	763	758	749
Marketing Costs	733	833	900	800	800	785	758	723
<u>Fixed Costs</u>	<u>564</u>	<u>570</u>	<u>580</u>	<u>482</u>	<u>491</u>	<u>492</u>	<u>491</u>	<u>487</u>
Total Costs	2,089	2,145	2,270	2,032	2,051	2,041	2,007	1,958
Variable Costs % of GMS	6.0%	5.9%	6.6%	6.9%	7.0%	7.1%	7.2%	7.3%
Marketing Costs % of GMS	5.6%	6.6%	7.6%	7.4%	7.4%	7.3%	7.2%	7.0%
<u>Fixed Costs % of GMS</u>	<u>4.3%</u>	<u>4.5%</u>	<u>4.9%</u>	<u>4.5%</u>	<u>4.5%</u>	<u>4.6%</u>	<u>4.7%</u>	<u>4.7%</u>
Total Costs % of GMS	15.9%	17.0%	19.0%	18.8%	19.0%	19.0%	19.0%	19.0%
EBITDA	754	782	735	815	797	731	640	519
y/y change		3.6%	-6.0%	11.0%	-2.2%	-8.3%	-12.5%	-18.9%
% delta vs. base case				-1%	-6%	-14%	-26%	-41%
EBITDA Margin	27.4%	27.8%	25.5%	29.3%	28.6%	26.9%	24.7%	21.4%
y/y change (bps)		38	-236	378	-61	-176	-223	-326
% delta vs. base case (bps)				-25	-80	-202	-421	-742

Source: Company Data, Morgan Stanley Research

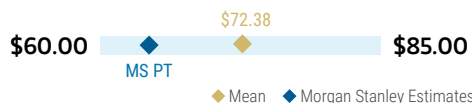
Risk Reward – Etsy Inc (ETSY.N)

Signs of Reacceleration on Very Depressed Comps

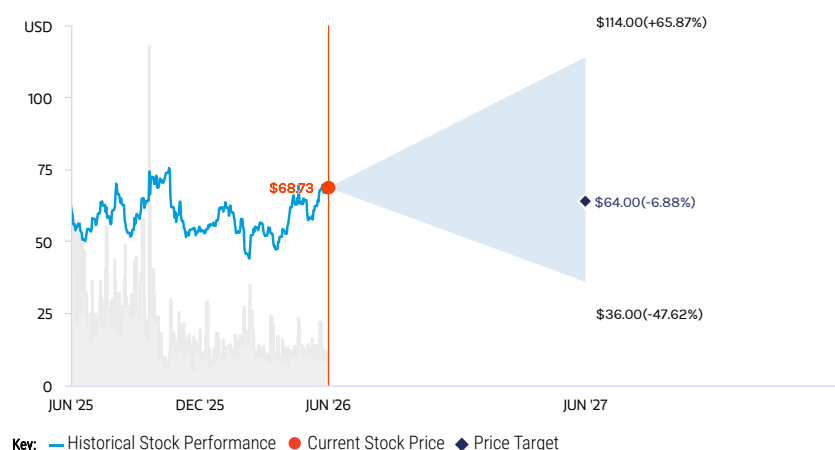
PRICE TARGET \$64.00

Price target of \$64 implies ~7x 2027E EBITDA. Our price target is based on a DCF valuation with an 8.1% WACC and a 1.0% terminal growth rate (~30% terminal EBITDA margin).

Consensus Price Target Distribution



RISK REWARD CHART

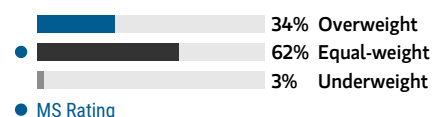


Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

EQUAL-WEIGHT THESIS

- After struggling to find the bottom post-COVID, ETSY has reaccelerated through 2025 on easing comps & a less competitive ad market. With a more stable macro, we believe ETSY has returned to slightly positive core GMS growth.
- However, we still have fundamental concerns around core ETSY's low purchase frequency as ~50% of the buyers shop once per year with an average GMS per buyer of ~\$120. We are skeptical on its ability to improve this metric long-term, limiting its growth opportunity.
- Agentic commerce widens the risk-reward profile by creating greater opportunity for share gain, offset by take rate & margin risk.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Risk Reward Themes

Secular Growth: *Negative*
Technology Diffusion: *Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes [here](#)

BULL CASE

\$114.00

11x Bull Case 2027E EV/EBITDA

Well-Crafted. Core GMS reacceleration proves sustainable as more balanced R&D starts to bend the retention curve, creating more stackable cohorts and reducing marketing spend. Following Depop's sale, we see a rebound to LSD top-line growth in '27 onwards with a ~3% top-line CAGR from FY25-FY30. Operating and marketing leverage enable high incremental margins with EBITDA margin rising to 32% by '27 and 35% long-term.

BASE CASE

\$64.00

7x Base Case 2027E EV/EBITDA

Loose Threads. Our Base case assumes core Etsy growth is pressured post Depop, with a mix of slight buyer growth and frequency. With modest annual take rate expansion, this implies flat revenue CAGR from FY25-FY30. Reduced marketing expenditure post Depop sale leads to EBITDA margin reaching ~29% in '27, though limited forward conviction in top-line results in muted margin expansion to ~30% LT.

BEAR CASE

\$36.00

5x Bear Case 2027E EV/EBITDA

Unraveled. Struggles to drive retention & frequency worsen, leading to persistent core GMS declines. Agentic pressures take rates, leading to worse flow-through and pressures LTV/CAC. Lower revenue growth leads to less operating leverage while the company increases investment to try and recreate growth, keeping EBITDA margins at only ~26% in 2030.

Risk Reward – Etsy Inc (ETSY.N)

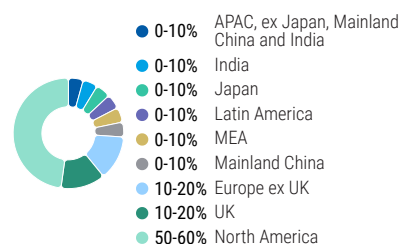
KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	2025	2026e	2027e	2028e
Core GMS growth (%)	(3.9)	3.4	1.8	1.7
LTM Active Buyers	93.5	87.2	87.8	88.4
EBITDA Margin (%)	25.5	29.5	29.4	28.9
GMS (\$, mm)	11,916.9	10,815.0	11,007.2	11,190.4

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- Etsy's active sellers and buyers form a global online marketplace to buy and sell unique items.
- Etsy's marketplace is relatively asset-light and does not contain any inventory risk.
- Take rate has increased through new or improved seller services.

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies [here](#)

MS ALPHA MODELS

1/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	1/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon
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Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- AI-powered improvements to search & discovery drive sustainable frequency gains
- LTV/CAC expansion enables larger, stackable cohorts
- Agentic commerce drives share gains by helping surface long-tail items

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- 2025's core GMS improvement proves more tactical as ETSY struggles to maintain positive growth
- A diminished LTV/CAC limits net adds
- Agentic commerce increases competition, pressuring take rate

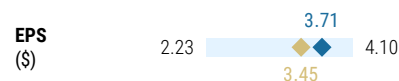
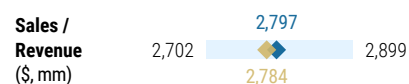
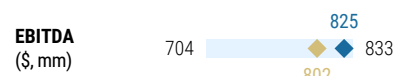
OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	40.6%				
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	1.7x				
HF Sector Net Exposure	11.1%				

Refinitiv; MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure - Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2026e



◆ Mean ◆ Morgan Stanley Estimates

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

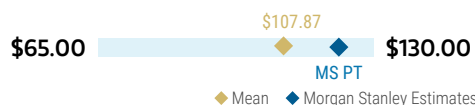
Risk Reward – eBay Inc (EBAY.O)

Sustaining Outsized GMV Growth

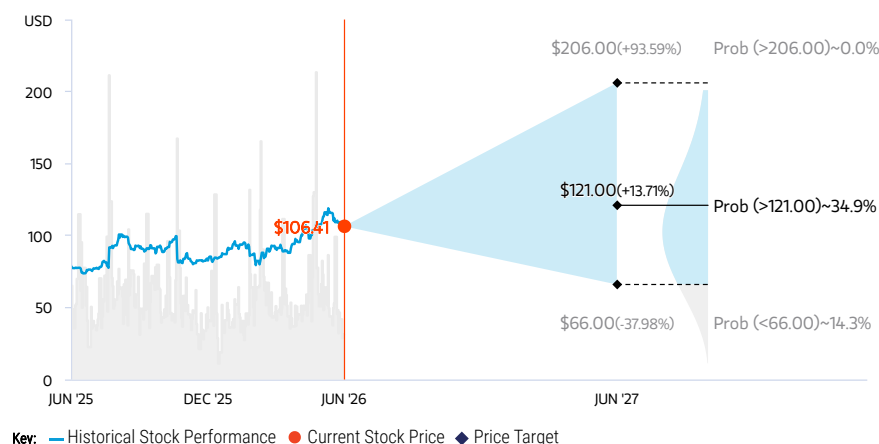
PRICE TARGET \$121.00

We model EBAY using a discounted cash flow with a 7.5% WACC and a 2.0% perpetuity growth rate. This implies a ~16x FY27 adj. EPS multiple or ~13.4x '27 adj. EBITDA.

Consensus Price Target Distribution



RISK REWARD CHART AND OPTIONS IMPLIED PROBABILITIES (12M)

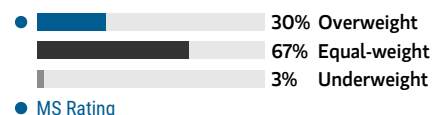


Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research, Morgan Stanley Institutional Equities Division. The probabilities of our Bull, Base, and Bear case scenarios playing out were estimated with implied volatility data from the options market as of 10 Jun 2026. All figures are approximate risk-neutral probabilities of the stock reaching beyond the scenario price in either three-months' or one-years' time. View explanation of Options Probabilities methodology [here](#)

OVERWEIGHT THESIS

- We believe EBAY has returned to durable GMV growth through an improved buyer experience stacking many small initiatives along with an easing competitive environment. GMV growth and take rate expansion should drive scale and lead to margin expansion.
- Each quarter of sustained, positive FXN GMV growth may help investors gain conviction in the MT growth story & help prove growth was not temporary/one-time.
- Despite similar growth profiles, EBAY trades at a discount to ETSY on '26 GAAP P/E which we believe provides justification for multiple expansion if EBAY executes.

Consensus Rating Distribution



Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Themes

Contrarian: *Positive*
Self-help: *Positive*
Technology Diffusion: *Positive*

View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes [here](#)

BULL CASE

\$206.00

~24x Bull 2027 adj. P/E

Vintage. In our bull case, EBAY's product development leads to meaningful innovation (assisted with AI-powered features) driving ~MSD-HSD positive GMV growth and slowing meaningful share losses. EBAY is able to leverage its cost base as a result and return to sustainable margin expansion. In this scenario, we assume a ~42% terminal EBITDA margin and a 2.8% perpetuity growth rate.

BASE CASE

\$121.00

~18x Base 2027 adj. P/E

Refurbished. In our base case, EBAY's balance of horizontal and vertical improvements leads to sustainably positive GMV growth at a 5% CAGR from FY25-FY30. We expect adj. EBIT margin expansion due to improved customer experience, take rate expansion, and fixed cost leverage. With the help of a substantial buyback, adj. EPS grows at a +LDD CAGR. In this scenario, we assume a ~35% terminal EBITDA margin and a 2.0% perpetuity growth rate.

BEAR CASE

\$66.00

~11x Bear 2027 adj. P/E

Bidless. In our bear case, a consumer slow-down hurts key categories and pushes EBAY's growth flat with initiatives unable to offset. This leads to scale-based deleverage. In this scenario, we assume a ~32% terminal EBITDA margin and a 0.5% perpetuity growth rate.

Risk Reward – eBay Inc (EBAY.O)

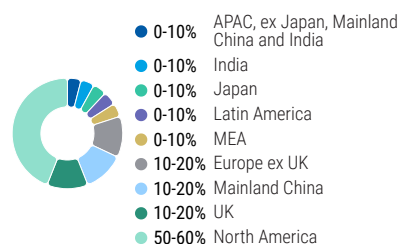
KEY EARNINGS INPUTS

Drivers	2025	2026e	2027e	2028e
Total GMV Y/Y Growth (ex-fx) (%)	5.8	8.4	4.7	3.9
Revenue (\$, mm)	11,100	12,265	13,290	14,171
Non-GAAP EPS (\$)	5.52	6.03	6.76	7.54

INVESTMENT DRIVERS

- GMV growth
- Take rate expansion
- Enthusiast customer growth
- EBITDA margin expansion

GLOBAL REVENUE EXPOSURE



Source: Morgan Stanley Research Estimate
View explanation of regional hierarchies [here](#)

MS ALPHA MODELS

3/5 BEST	24 Month Horizon	2/5 MOST	3 Month Horizon
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Source: Refinitiv, FactSet, Morgan Stanley Research; 1 is the highest favored Quintile and 5 is the least favored Quintile

RISKS TO PT/RATING

RISKS TO UPSIDE

- eBay's strategy evolution drives ~HSD GMV growth and incremental margin
- Take rate expansion happens enables better monetization, flowing primarily to the bottom line
- AI-features drive sustainable growth and cost leverage

RISKS TO DOWNSIDE

- The company's horizontal & focus category investments are unable to drive growth
- EBAY has to further increase investment in an attempt to maintain growth

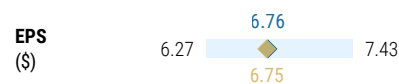
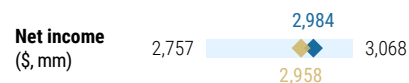
OWNERSHIP POSITIONING

Inst. Owners, % Active	49.9%	
HF Sector Long/Short Ratio	1.7x	
HF Sector Net Exposure	11.1%	

Refinitiv; MSPB Content. Includes certain hedge fund exposures held with MSPB. Information may be inconsistent with or may not reflect broader market trends. Long/Short Ratio = Long Exposure / Short exposure. Sector % of Total Net Exposure = (For a particular sector: Long Exposure - Short Exposure) / (Across all sectors: Long Exposure – Short Exposure).

MS ESTIMATES VS. CONSENSUS

FY Dec 2027e



◆ Mean ◆ Morgan Stanley Estimates

Source: Refinitiv, Morgan Stanley Research

Risk Reward Reference links

1. View explanation of Options Probabilities methodology - [Options_Probabilities_Exhibit_Link.pdf](#)
2. View descriptions of Risk Rewards Themes - [RR_Themes_Exhibit_Link.pdf](#)
3. View explanation of regional hierarchies - [GEG_Exhibit_Link.pdf](#)
4. View explanation of Theme/Exposure methodology - [ESG_Sustainable_Solutions_External_Link.pdf](#)
5. View explanation of HERS methodology - [ESG_HERS_External_Link.pdf](#)

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Global Stock Ratings Distribution

(as of May 31, 2026)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1542	42%	465	51%	30%	707	43%
Equal-weight/Hold	1571	43%	369	40%	23%	723	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	0	0%	0%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	551	15%	86	9%	16%	201	12%
Total	3,667		920			1632	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Overweight (O). The stock's total return is expected to exceed the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

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Not-Rated (NR). Currently the analyst does not have adequate conviction about the stock's total return relative to the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Underweight (U). The stock's total return is expected to be below the average total return of the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage universe, on a risk-adjusted basis, over the next 12-18 months.

Unless otherwise specified, the time frame for price targets included in Morgan Stanley Research is 12 to 18 months.

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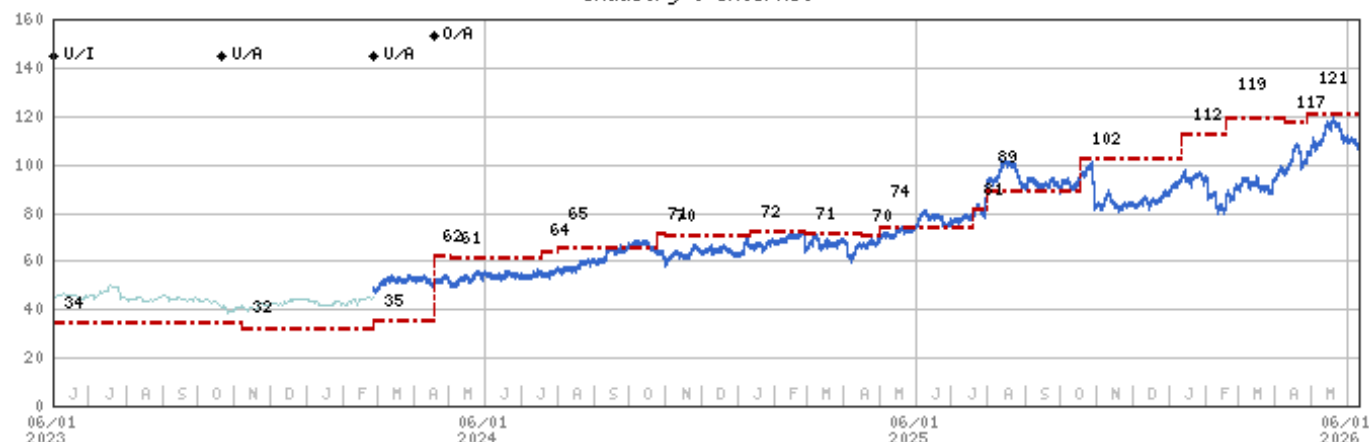
Attractive (A): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be attractive vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

In-Line (I): The analyst expects the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months to be in line with the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Cautious (C): The analyst views the performance of his or her industry coverage universe over the next 12-18 months with caution vs. the relevant broad market benchmark, as indicated below.

Benchmarks for each region are as follows: North America - S&P 500; Latin America - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI Latin America Index; Europe - MSCI Europe; Japan - TOPIX; Asia - relevant MSCI country index or MSCI sub-regional index or MSCI AC Asia Pacific ex Japan Index.

Stock Price, Price Target and Rating History (See Rating Definitions)

eBay Inc (EBAY.O) - As of 06/11/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Internet

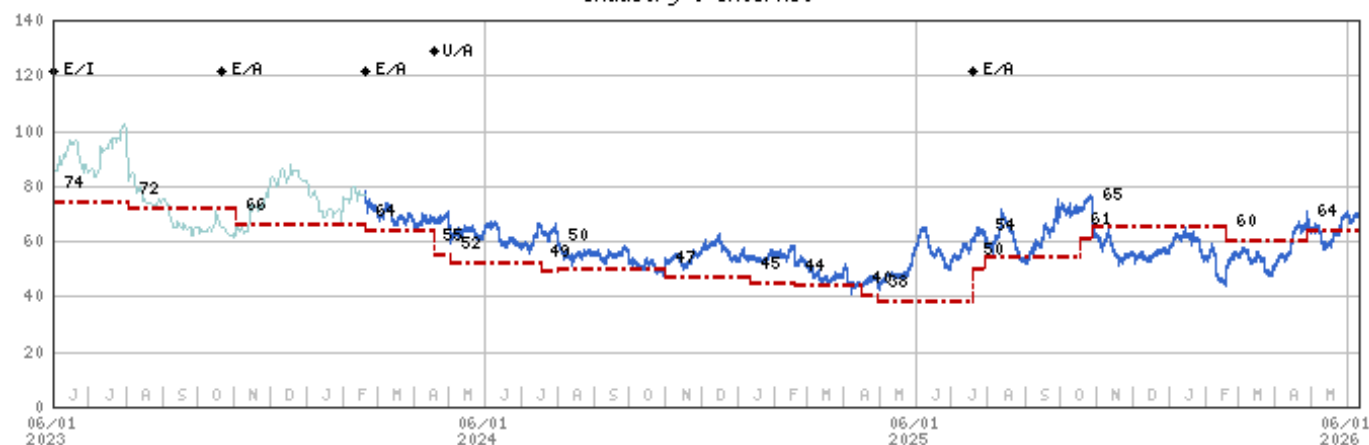
Stock Rating History: 6/1/21 : E/I; 6/24/21 : NA/I; 6/23/22 : U/I; 10/22/23 : U/A; 2/28/24 : U/A; 4/18/24 : O/A

Price Target History: 2/4/21 : 63; 6/24/21 : NA; 6/23/22 : 36; 8/3/22 : 37; 10/24/22 : 33; 11/3/22 : 34; 1/17/23 : 32; 2/27/23 : 33; 4/26/23 : 34; 11/8/23 : 32; 2/28/24 : 35; 4/18/24 : 62; 5/2/24 : 61; 7/18/24 : 64; 8/1/24 : 65; 10/25/24 : 71; 10/31/24 : 70; 1/12/25 : 72; 2/27/25 : 71; 4/16/25 : 70; 5/1/25 : 74; 7/20/25 : 81; 7/31/25 : 89; 10/19/25 : 102; 1/12/26 : 112; 2/19/26 : 119; 4/9/26 : 117; 4/29/26 : 121

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
 Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
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 Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

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Etsy Inc (ETSY.N) - As of 06/11/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Internet

Stock Rating History: 6/1/21 : U/I; 8/4/21 : E/I; 10/22/23 : E/A; 2/21/24 : E/A; 4/18/24 : U/A; 7/20/25 : E/A

Price Target History: 5/5/21 : 135; 8/4/21 : 163; 11/4/21 : 179; 1/19/22 : 154; 5/4/22 : 113; 7/27/22 : 83; 10/24/22 : 75; 11/2/22 : 76; 1/17/23 : 75; 2/22/23 : 74; 5/3/23 : 79; 5/15/23 : 74; 8/3/23 : 72; 11/2/23 : 66; 2/21/24 : 64; 4/18/24 : 55; 5/2/24 : 52; 7/18/24 : 49; 8/1/24 : 50; 10/31/24 : 47; 1/12/25 : 45; 2/19/25 : 44; 4/16/25 : 40; 4/30/25 : 38; 7/20/25 : 50; 7/30/25 : 54; 10/19/25 : 61; 10/29/25 : 65; 2/19/26 : 60; 4/29/26 : 64

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
 Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
 Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
 Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
 Industry View: Attractive (A) In-line (I) Cautious (C) No Rating (NR)

Effective January 13, 2014, the stocks covered by Morgan Stanley Asia Pacific will be rated relative to the analyst's industry (or industry team's) coverage.

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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Internet

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (06/10/2026)
Brian Nowak, CFA Airbnb Inc (ABNB.O)	U (12/06/2022)	\$129.10

Alphabet Inc. (GOOGL.O)	O (08/11/2015)	\$356.38
Amazon.com Inc (AMZN.O)	O (04/24/2015)	\$238.00
Booking Holdings Inc (BKNG.O)	O (02/23/2026)	\$160.64
DoorDash Inc (DASH.O)	O (02/21/2024)	\$151.00
Expedia Inc. (EXPE.O)	E (01/09/2019)	\$218.94
Instacart (CART.O)	E (01/29/2024)	\$41.21
Lyft Inc (LYFT.O)	E (10/24/2019)	\$13.39
Meta Platforms Inc (META.O)	O (03/20/2023)	\$570.98
Pinterest Inc (PINS.N)	O (07/20/2025)	\$21.77
Reddit Inc (RDDT.N)	O (12/08/2024)	\$172.21
Snap Inc. (SNAP.N)	E (07/22/2024)	\$5.38
Uber Technologies Inc (UBER.N)	O (06/04/2019)	\$68.61
Matthew Cost		
AppLovin Corp (APP.O)	O (04/10/2025)	\$492.98
Compass, Inc. (COMP.N)	E (01/12/2026)	\$7.91
Criteo SA (CRO.O)	E (01/26/2016)	\$17.63
DoubleVerify Holdings Inc (DV.N)	E (06/25/2024)	\$10.32
Electronic Arts Inc (EA.O)	E (08/04/2021)	\$203.20
MNTN Inc (MNTN.N)	E (06/16/2025)	\$8.53
Opendoor Technologies Inc (OPEN.O)	E (07/24/2023)	\$4.48
Playtika Holding Corp (PLTK.O)	E (11/27/2022)	\$3.15
Roblox Corporation (RBLX.N)	O (11/04/2024)	\$41.50
Shutterstock Inc (SSTK.N)	E (07/28/2022)	\$13.70
Take-Two Interactive Software (TTWO.O)	O (02/01/2018)	\$210.46
Trade Desk Inc (TTD.O)	E (09/10/2025)	\$19.29
Unity Software Inc (U.N)	O (09/02/2024)	\$26.66
Webtoon Entertainment Inc (WBTN.O)	E (07/22/2024)	\$11.20
Yelp Inc (YELP.N)	U (01/10/2019)	\$24.28
Zillow Group Inc (Z.O)	E (04/18/2018)	\$33.93
Nathan Feather		
Bumble Inc. (BMBL.O)	E (03/08/2021)	\$2.71
Chewy Inc (CHWY.N)	O (10/31/2023)	\$19.98
Duolingo Inc (DUOL.O)	E (02/27/2026)	\$121.92
eBay Inc (EBAY.O)	O (04/18/2024)	\$106.41
Etsy Inc (ETSY.N)	E (07/20/2025)	\$68.73
FIGS, Inc. (FIGS.N)	E (02/29/2024)	\$11.48
Grindr Inc. (GRND.N)	E (02/24/2026)	\$11.58
Match Group Inc (MTCH.O)	E (04/18/2024)	\$34.35
Peloton Interactive, Inc. (PTON.O)	E (03/14/2022)	\$5.59
Revolve Group Inc (RVLV.N)	E (10/20/2024)	\$20.35
WW International Inc (WW.O)	E (08/01/2025)	\$18.47

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.